

27 August 2026

Dear Hiring Team,

There's something I admire about a business that stays farmer-owned while building brands the whole region reaches for — Puck and Lurpak are fixtures of the Middle Eastern kitchen, and Arla's invitation to 'shape the future of dairy' is exactly the kind of category challenge I want. As a category and commercial manager based in Dubai, working across FMCG in this market every day, the Market Category Expert role reads like the brief I've been building toward: turning regional strategy into local category growth that resonates with our customers, consumers and shoppers.

Category work is the spine of my career. I built the foundation at Mondelez, a global FMCG leader — running sell-in/sell-out and Nielsen analysis, evaluating promotional effectiveness and assessing planogram compliance and assortment gaps for the chocolate category, then supporting NPD from concept to shelf (Milka Spread, Mini Suchard). At Alibaba's Miravia I owned a category across 42 accounts and grew GMV +30% QoQ through assortment, pricing, margin and a data-led promotional calendar. Today at DoFreeze I own category and the 4P across 50+ markets — localising toolkits and trade decks, designing promo menus by channel, leading NPD end-to-end and building bottom-up business cases to unlock growth.

The way this role works is the way I work: shopper and consumer understanding turned into strategic direction, pricing and promotions optimised with a net-revenue mindset, and market presence driven through disciplined retail execution — all evidenced with Nielsen and EPOS/sell-out data. I'll be candid that my category depth has been in FMCG food and beauty rather than dairy specifically, and I'm at 4+ years against your six — but the 4P, NRM and Nielsen muscle transfers directly, I ramp fast on a new category, and I'm AI-first in how I pull insight and build decks. I'm also already based in Dubai on a UAE residence visa, so there's no relocation timeline.

I'd love to bring this blend of category-planning rigour, NPD and commercial execution to Arla's growth in the region. I'm in Dubai, available to start quickly, and happy to talk ahead of the 4 September close about how I'd localise the strategy, sharpen the 4P and turn shopper insight into category wins. Thank you for your consideration — I hope we get to speak.

Best regards,

Paula De Francisco Pérez

+971 50 386 3656 | paulich98@hotmail.com